Alex N. Merrill

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Education:

Master of Arts in Information and Library Science, December 2004
School of Information Resources and Library Science, University of Arizona, Tucson, Arizona
Areas of Concentration: Information Technology Management, Metadata, Statistics

Bachelor of Science in History, July 2000
Ball State University, Muncie, Indiana
Areas of Concentration: Computer Science, Latin American History

Library Experience:

Washington State University, Pullman, Washington, 2005 – present

Libraries
Associate Dean for Technology and Operations – December 2025 - present
Head of Systems and Technical Operations – August 2014 – December 2025
Assistant Dean for Operations (Interim) - July 2013 – August 2014
Head, Systems (Interim) – July 2013 – August 2014
Digital Initiatives Librarian, August 2005 – August 2014

Center for Digital Scholarship and Curation
Co-Director – 2024 - present
Director of Technology – 2015 - present

University of Arizona Main Library (UAML), Tucson, Arizona, 2003-2005
Digital Projects Specialist (Temporary Staff), January 2005 – July 2005

Selected Grants:

Mukurtu Shared: Phase III
Merrill, Alex (Co-PI); Christen, Kimberly (PI)
Amount Funded: $1,500,000
Agency: Andrew W. Mellon Foundation
3/1/2024 – 2/28/2027

Sustaining Mukurtu CMS: Community-Centered Collections Stewardship,
Merrill, Alex (Co-PI); Christen, Kimberly (PI); Taylor, Steve (Co-PI)
Amount funded: $799,792.00
Agency IMLS
09/1/2022-08/31/2025

Collaborative Curation and Digital Stewardship with Mukurtu Shared
Merrill, Alex (Co-PI); Christen, Kimberly (PI); Bond, Trevor (Co-PI)
Amount funded: $700,000.00
Agency: Andrew W. Mellon Foundation

10/1/2020-09/30/2023

Culturally Responsive Indigenous Science (CRIS): Connecting Land, Language and Culture for Indigenous STEM (ISTEM) Education: Merrill, Alex (Collaborator); Christen, Kimberly (Co-PI); Price P.G (PI); Strong, Z. (Co-PI)
Amount Funded: $2,481,274.00
Agency: National Science Foundation
09/1/2017-08/31/2021

Tribal Digital Stewardship Cohort Training: Cultural and Collaborative Curation Models and Methods
Merrill, Alex (Co-PI); Christen, Kimberly (PI); Bond, Trevor (Co-PI)
Amount funded: $449,726.00
Agency: IMLS
10/1/2017-09/30/2020

Selected Contributed Software Releases and Projects:

Mukurtu CMS 3.X

Christen, K.A., Merrill, A., Deer, N., Wynne, M.K.B (2025). Mukurtu CMS 3.0.7
https://github.com/MukurtuCMS/mukurtucms/releases/tag/3.0.7

Christen, K.A., Merrill, A., Deer, N., Wynne, M.K.B (2024). Mukurtu CMS 3.0.6
https://github.com/MukurtuCMS/mukurtucms/releases/tag/3.0.6

Christen, K. A., Merrill, A., Taylor, S., Wynne, M. K. B. (2023). *Mukurtu CMS 3.0.5*
https://github.com/MukurtuCMS/mukurtucms/releases/tag/3.0.5

Christen, K. A., Merrill, A., Taylor, S., Wynne, M. K. B. (2023). *Mukurtu CMS 3.0.4*
https://github.com/MukurtuCMS/mukurtucms/releases/tag/3.0.4

Mukurtu CMS 4.X

Christen, K.A., Merrill, A., Deer, N., Wynne, M.K.B. (2025 - ongoing). Mukurtu CMS 4.X
https://github.com/MukurtuCMS/Mukurtu-CMS

Digital collection support and sites

Merrill, A., Sun, R., Clements, W. (2021) Fallen Cougars Collection site
https://github.com/WSU-CDSC/fallencougars

Merrill, A., Weaver, A. (ongoing) WSU Digital Collection User Interface Repository
https://github.com/WSU-CDSC/responsivedm

Merrill, A., Weaver, A. (ongoing) WSU Digital Preservation Microservices Repository
https://github.com/WSU-CDSC/microservices

Discovery Layer Framework for testing:

Merrill, A., Galbreath., B, Johnson, C. (2021) A Framework for Measuring Relevancy in Discovery Environments
https://osf.io/ve3kp/

Merrill, A. (2021 - 2025) Ongoing code and R Studio environment in support of discovery layer relevancy testing
https://github.com/alexmerrill/discovery-layer-paper-2

Selected Publications:

Merrill, A., Galbreath, B., Johnson, C.M. (2024). A Framework for Measuring Relevancy in Discovery Environments: Increasing Scalability and Reproducibility. *Information Technology and Libraries*, 43(2), 1-18.

Merrill, A., Galbreath, B., Johnson, C.M. (2021). A Framework for Measuring Relevancy in Discovery Environments. *Information Technology and Libraries*, 40(2), 1-17.

Christen, K. A., Merrill, A., Wynne, M. K. B. (2017). A Community of Relations: Mukurtu Hubs and Spokes. *D-Lib Magazine, 23*(5/6).

Blakesley, E.A. & Merrill, A. (eds)(2011). *Public Services Quarterly: Library 2.0, 7(3/4).*

Merrill, A. (2011). Library+. *Public Services Quarterly*, 7(3/4). 144-148

Merrill, A, & Cornish, A.K. (2010) Enabling Integrated, Online Access to Special Collections. *Technical Services Quarterly, 27(2), 151-163.*

Cummings, J., Merrill, A., & Borrelli, S. (2010) The Use of Handheld Mobile Devices: Their Impact on Library Catalogs. *Library Hi Tech, 28(1), 22-40.*

Vonseggern, M.K., Merrill, A., & Zhu, L. (2010). Sense of Place in Digital Collections. *OCLC Systems & Services: International digital library perspectives, 26(4).*

Merrill, A., & Blakesley, E.A, (2009). Growing your own: Building an internal leadership training program. *Library Leadership & Management, 23(2), 85-87.*

Regional Library Service:

Orbis-Cascade Alliance Open-Source ILS Committee September 2023 - present
Orbis-Cascade Alliance Systems Team May 2015 – June 2016
Orbis-Cascade Alliance Primo Joint Assessment Working Group 2015 -2016
National Digital Newspaper Digitization Program Steering Committee (Wash State Library), 2007-

Washington State University:

Digital Accessibility Committee (University Committee), 2024 – present
Area Technology Officers (University Committee), 2015- present
Web Advisory Group (Library Committee), 2022 – present
Library Faculty Affairs Committee – 2025 - 2026
Accessible Technology Committee (University Committee), 2020 – 2023
Area Technology Officers (University Committee), 2013 - present
Information Technology Strategic Advisory Committee, 2019 - 2025
Faculty Senate, 2009- 2012
Parking & Transportation Task Force, 2009 – 2010

Professional Society Membership:

Association of Tribal, Archives and Libraries and Museums (ATALM)
Core: Leadership, Infrastructure, Futures (division of the American Library Association)
Northwest Archivists